Era 20: Civil Rights Movement

1954–1968 · APUSH Period 8 · Lessons 48–50

Name _____ Due _____

This is your study guide for the whole era. Complete each lesson section as you study it, using your class notes and textbook: read the AP topic(s) listed for the lesson in your textbook, define every term, person and event in your own words, then answer the Key Question in 3–5 sentences with specific evidence. Each lesson is checked and stamped in class; the whole guide is collected and graded at the end of the era. **Before the end-of-era test:** finish the Era Wrap-Up, then reread the whole guide. Fix or add anything in a different color.

Lesson 48 *Brown to Birmingham · nonviolence*

8.6 (LO G): Explain how and why the civil rights movements developed and expanded from 1945 to 1960.
8.10 (LO L): Explain how and why various groups responded to calls for the expansion of civil rights from 1960 to 1980.

Read (AP topics in your textbook): Topic 8.6 *Early Steps in the Civil Rights Movement (1940s and 1950s)* · Topic 8.10 *The African American Civil Rights Movement (1960s)*

STAMP

Terms

Define it in your own words and explain why it matters.

1. **SCLC**

2. **SNCC**

3. **massive resistance**

4. **civil disobedience**

People

Who they were and why they matter.

5. **Thurgood Marshall**

6. **Martin Luther King Jr.**

Events

What happened and why it matters.

7. **Mendez v. Westminster (1947)**

8. **Brown v. Board of Education (1954)**

9. **Hernandez v. Texas (1954)**

10. **Emmett Till murdered (1955)**

11. **Montgomery Bus Boycott (Rosa Parks) (1955–56)**

12. **Little Rock Nine (1957)**

13. **Greensboro sit-ins (1960)**

14. **Freedom Rides (1961)**

15. **Birmingham campaign (1963)**

16. **March on Washington – "I Have a Dream" (1963)**

Lesson 48 · Key Question *Brown to Birmingham · nonviolence*

8.6 (LO G): Explain how and why the civil rights movements developed and expanded from 1945 to 1960.
8.10 (LO L): Explain how and why various groups responded to calls for the expansion of civil rights from 1960 to 1980.

Explain how court victories and nonviolent direct action challenged segregation between 1954 and 1963.

Answer in 3–5 sentences. Make a clear claim, support it with at least two specific pieces of evidence from this lesson, and explain how the evidence supports your claim.

Lesson 49 *Legislation & the movement's peak*

8.10 (LO L): Explain how and why various groups responded to calls for the expansion of civil rights from 1960 to 1980.

Read (AP topic in your textbook): Topic 8.10 *The African American Civil Rights Movement (1960s)*

STAMP

Terms

Define it in your own words and explain why it matters.

17. **24th Amendment**

18. **Mississippi Freedom Democratic Party (Fannie Lou Hamer)**

Events

What happened and why it matters.

19. **Civil Rights Act of 1964**

20. **Freedom Summer (1964)**

21. **"Bloody Sunday" (John Lewis) (Mar. 1965)**

22. **Selma to Montgomery marches (1965)**

23. **Voting Rights Act of 1965**

Lesson 49 · Key Question *Legislation & the movement's peak*

8.10 (LO L): Explain how and why various groups responded to calls for the expansion of civil rights from 1960 to 1980.

Explain how the civil rights movement won passage of the Civil Rights Act of 1964 and the Voting Rights Act of 1965, and what each law did.

Answer in 3–5 sentences. Make a clear claim, support it with at least two specific pieces of evidence from this lesson, and explain how the evidence supports your claim.

Lesson 50 *Black Power · Malcolm X · MLK's death*

8.10 (LO L): Explain how and why various groups responded to calls for the expansion of civil rights from 1960 to 1980.
8.11 (LO L): Explain how and why various groups responded to calls for the expansion of civil rights from 1960 to 1980.

Read (AP topics in your textbook): Topic 8.10 *The African American Civil Rights Movement (1960s)* · Topic 8.11 *The Civil Rights Movement Expands*

STAMP

Terms

Define it in your own words and explain why it matters.

24. Black Power (Stokely Carmichael)

25. Black Panthers (Huey Newton)

26. Nation of Islam

27. urban uprisings

28. Warren Court

People

Who they were and why they matter.

29. Malcolm X

Events

What happened and why it matters.

30. Gideon v. Wainwright (1963)

31. **Watts uprising (1965)**

32. **Miranda v. Arizona (1966)**

33. **Loving v. Virginia (1967)**

34. **MLK assassinated (1968)**

35. **Kerner Commission (1968)**

Lesson 50 · Key Question *Black Power · Malcolm X · MLK's death*

8.10 (LO L): Explain how and why various groups responded to calls for the expansion of civil rights from 1960 to 1980.
8.11 (LO L): Explain how and why various groups responded to calls for the expansion of civil rights from 1960 to 1980.

Explain why some activists turned toward Black Power after 1965 and how the Warren Court expanded individual rights in the 1960s.

Answer in 3–5 sentences. Make a clear claim, support it with at least two specific pieces of evidence from this lesson, and explain how the evidence supports your claim.

Era Wrap-Up *complete before the end-of-era test*

Strategies of the Civil Rights Movement

Strategy	Example (year)	Key people or groups	Result
Court challenges			
Boycotts			
Sit-ins			
Freedom Rides			
Marches & demonstrations			
Black Power			

Landmark Rulings and Laws

Ruling or law (year)	What it did	Why it mattered
Brown v. Board of Education (1954)		
Civil Rights Act of 1964		
24th Amendment (1964)		
Voting Rights Act of 1965		
Loving v. Virginia (1967)		

AP Short-Answer Practice

Answer a, b and c. Each part is scored on its own, so answer each one directly in 1–3 sentences with specific historical evidence.

Chief Justice Earl Warren, opinion for a unanimous Supreme Court in Brown v. Board of Education of Topeka, May 17, 1954

Today, education is perhaps the most important function of state and local governments. Compulsory school attendance laws and the great expenditures for education both demonstrate our recognition of the importance of education to our democratic society. It is required in the performance of our most basic public responsibilities, even service in the armed forces. It is the very foundation of good citizenship.

[. . .]

Such considerations apply with added force to children in grade and high schools. To separate them from others of similar age and qualifications solely because of their race generates a feeling of inferiority as to their status in the community that may affect their hearts and minds in a way unlikely ever to be undone.

[. . .]

We conclude that in the field of public education the doctrine of "separate but equal" has no place. Separate educational facilities are inherently unequal.

Text: United States Reports, vol. 347, p. 483 (GovInfo). Excerpt; footnotes omitted.

a. Briefly describe the Court's reasoning in the excerpt.

b. Briefly explain ONE earlier legal decision or development that the ruling in the excerpt overturned or built upon.

c. Briefly explain ONE way individuals or groups responded to the decision between 1955 and 1965.

DBQ Practice · Complexity

PROMPT

Evaluate the relative importance of the federal government and grassroots activism in advancing African American civil rights from 1954 to 1968.

Your task: Using the document on this page as one piece of evidence, write 2–3 sentences that show a complex understanding: for example, explain how federal action and grassroots activism worked together, or use the document to qualify or modify an argument.

What earns the point: To earn the point, show a complex understanding of the prompt, for example by explaining multiple causes, connections across eras, continuity and change, or by corroborating, qualifying, or modifying an argument with evidence. It must be part of your argument, not a single phrase or passing reference.

John F. Kennedy, radio and television report to the American people on civil rights, June 11, 1963

We are confronted primarily with a moral issue. It is as old as the scriptures and is as clear as the American Constitution. The heart of the question is whether all Americans are to be afforded equal rights and equal opportunities, whether we are going to treat our fellow Americans as we want to be treated.

[. . .]

One hundred years of delay have passed since President Lincoln freed the slaves, yet their heirs, their grandsons, are not fully free. They are not yet freed from the bonds of injustice. They are not yet freed from social and economic oppression.

[. . .]

Next week I shall ask the Congress of the United States to act, to make a commitment it has not fully made in this century to the proposition that race has no place in American life or law.

Text: Teaching American History, Ashland University. Excerpt.

Connect forward — *Era 21 preview: the tactics and victories of the civil rights movement inspired women, Latinos, Native Americans, and students. Watch how those movements overlap with the Great Society and protests against the Vietnam War.*